Ako Pawlinska

Gameplay Designer

Cambridge • Ako@pawlinska.pl • akobunny.github.io/portfolio • www.linkedin.com/in/ako-pawlinska

PROFILE

Games design student who designs mechanics and rules and tunes game feel through testing, for example player acceleration and camera follow speed. Looking for a placement year from summer 2027.

PROJECTS

Final Altitude (Unity, C#, Ink; in progress, due Dec 2026): The game is about a war between humans and dwarves in a steampunk-fantasy setting where you play as a human mage flying around and defeating dwarven enemies. I design and code the game, right now focusing on the movement and camera mechanics.

Beep & Dig (Unity): The game is a short and simple game designed with a focus on UI to help you beat it rather than relying on tutorials. You must walk around a small island and dig mounds to find coins before time runs out, using a metal detector's signal strength meter and audible beeping to narrow down which mound a coin is under as to not waste time. I decided the game should have a consistent traffic-light colouring scheme to signal when something is helping or halting your progress and worked with playtesters to identify what parts of the game are instinctual and what needs to be made more obvious, without using a tutorial. I made the game using Unity's visual scripting.

Group pre-production, "Point of No Return" (team of 7): I am working as the Systems Designer as part of a group to create this game. My responsibilities are to design the core systems, game mechanics and gameplay loop sections.

SKILLS

Design: Tuning game feel through testing, UI design, design documentation.

Tools: Unity (C#, visual scripting), Ink, UE5 (blueprints)

Languages: English, Polish (conversational)

EDUCATION

Anglia Ruskin University, Cambridge — September 2025 – expected May 2029
BA (Hons) Computer Games Design

The University of Plymouth, Plymouth — September 2023 – April 2025
BSc (Hons) Marine Biology with Foundation Year

The Oakes College, Cambridge — 2021–2023
A-levels: Mathematics (C), Biology (C), Physics (D)

The Netherhall School, Cambridge — 2021
GCSEs: Biology 9, Physics 9, English Language 7, Drama 7, Mathematics 6, Computer Science 6

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Shop Worker — Nov–Dec 2024
Organised stock to cut search time, kept inventory records, and kept the shop clean and welcoming.

INTERESTS

Playing games: currently Deadlock and Genshin Impact, occasionally War Thunder, VALORANT, WARDOGS or Apex Legends.

Esports: I've participated in NSE (National Student Esports) tournaments including the VALORANT NSE Winter 25 and VALORANT Women & Non-Binary NSE Winter Cup 25 tournaments as the "duelist", entry fragger, for my team.